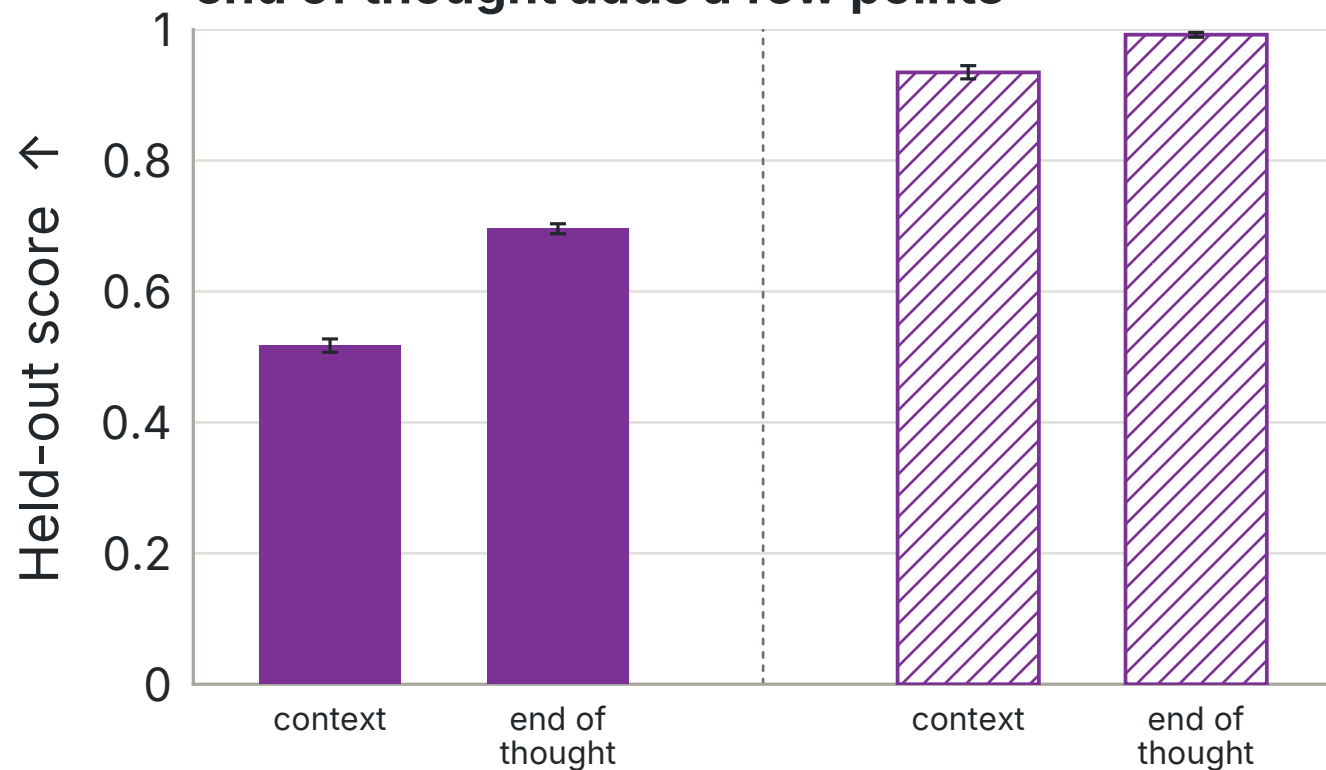


CORPORA

CoT-necessary questions only

A · OPENTHINKER3-7B, LAYER 19

**Context state already retrieves the answer;
end of thought adds a few points**

Held-out R^2

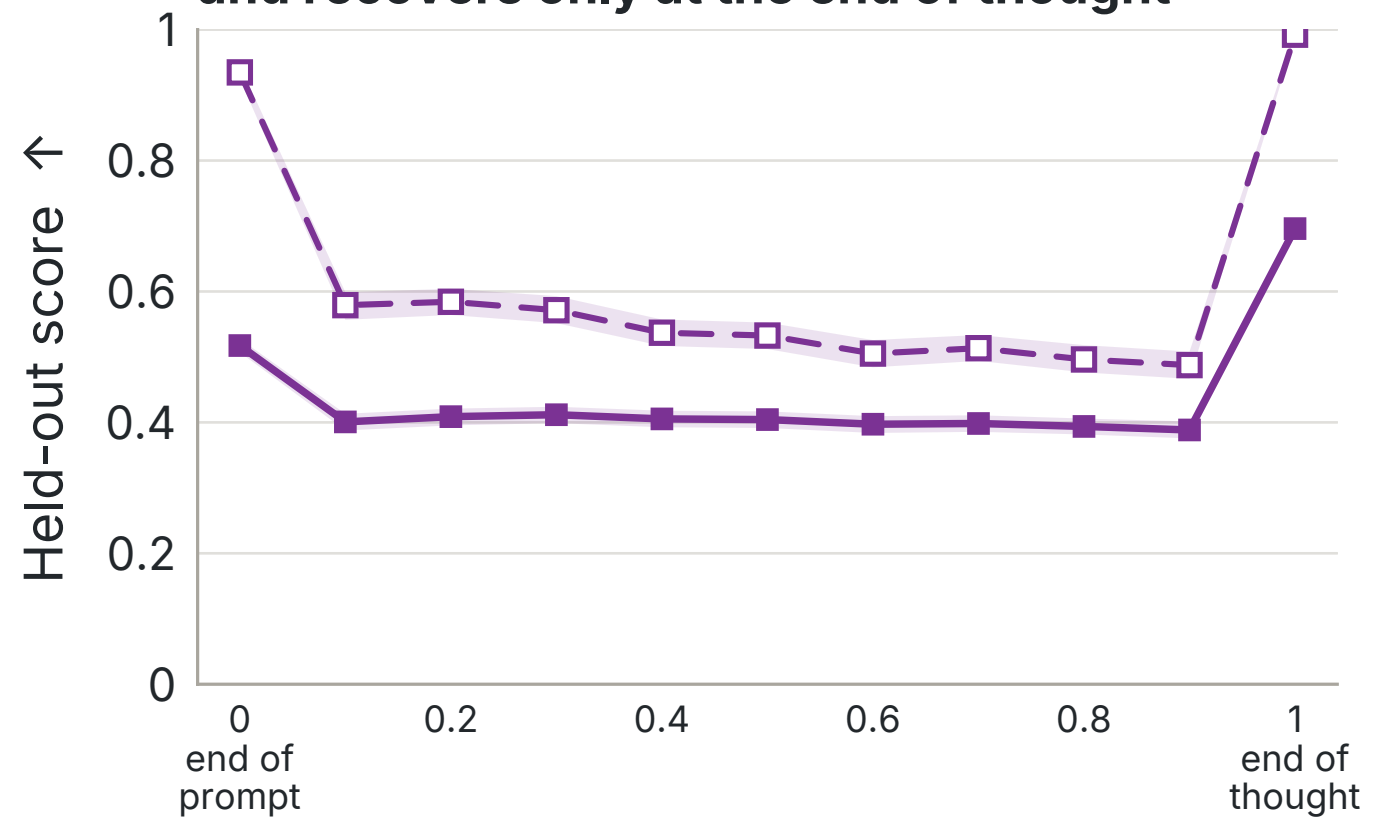
Answer retrieval (acc@1)

METRIC

Held-out R^2 Answer retrieval (acc@1)

B · OPENTHINKER3-7B, LAYER 19

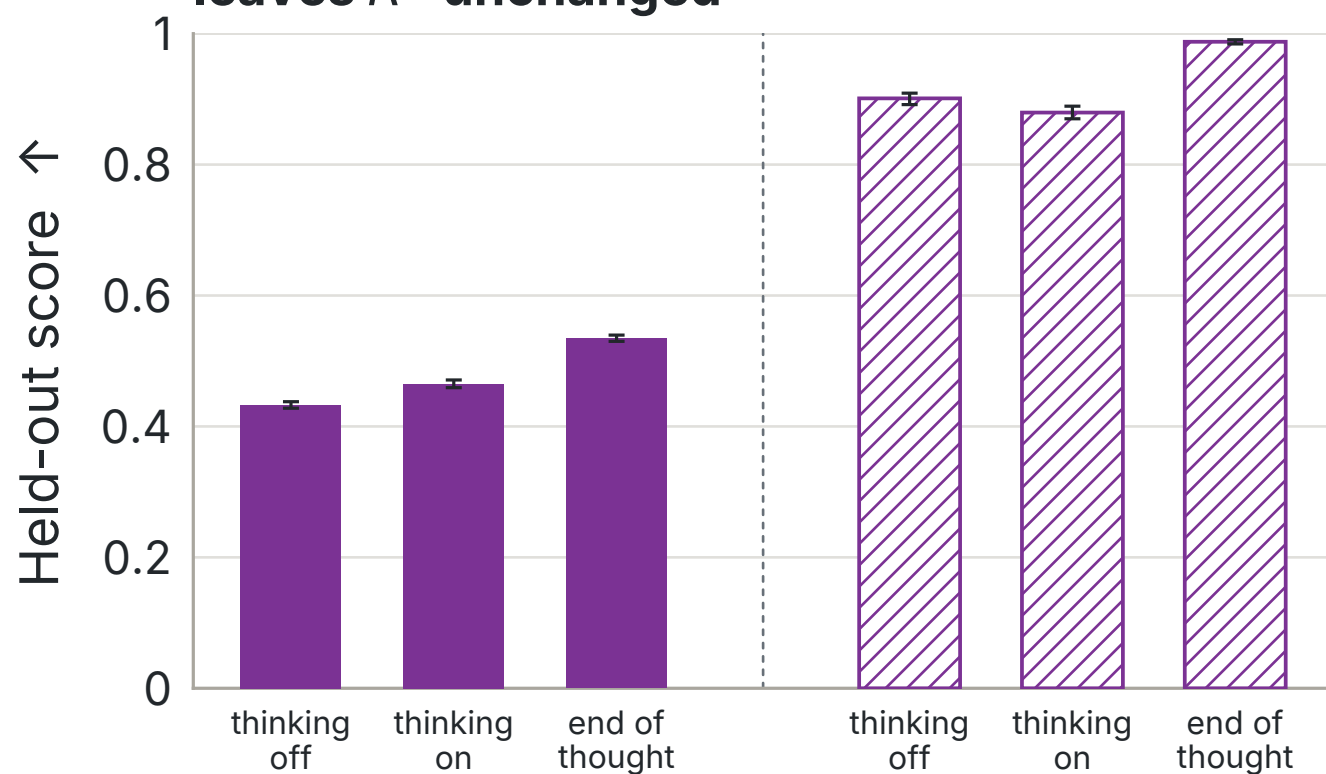
**Predictability dips inside the reasoning trace
and recovers only at the end of thought**



Position in the thinking span

C · QWEN3-8B, LAYER 24

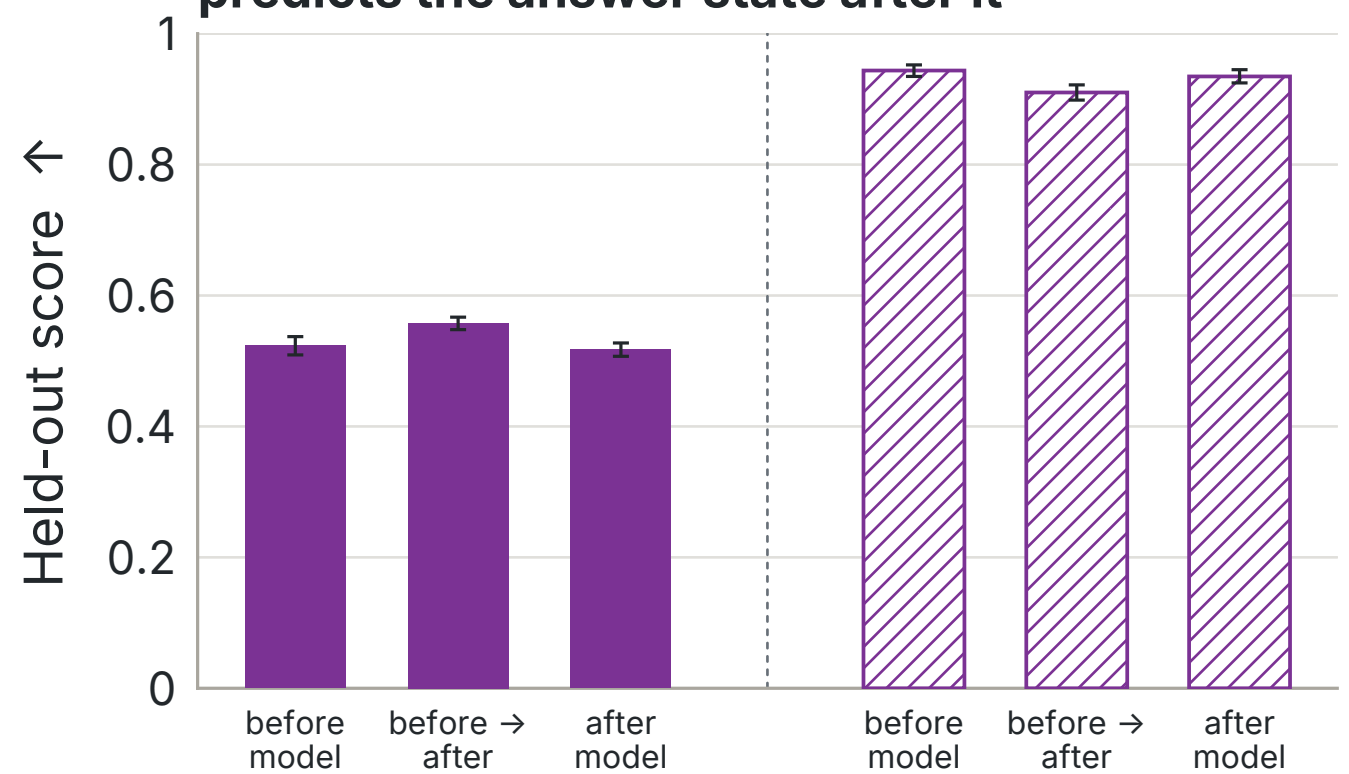
**Disabling thinking on the same weights
leaves R^2 unchanged**

Held-out R^2

Answer retrieval (acc@1)

D · QWEN2.5-7B-INSTRUCT (BEFORE) → OPENTHINKER3-7B (AFTER), LAYER 19

**The context state before reasoning training
predicts the answer state after it**

Held-out R^2

Answer retrieval (acc@1)